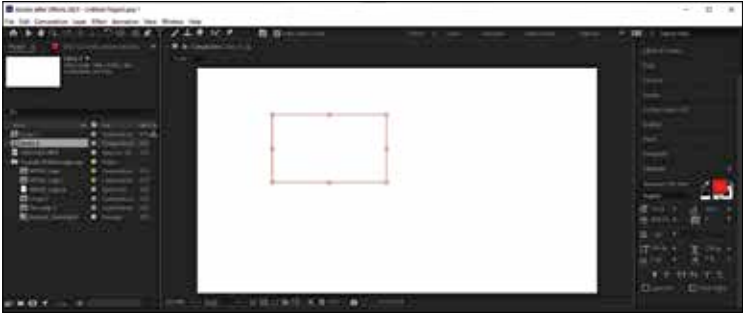




While using the Text tool, the Character section in the Work pane also drops down on the right

element or they have been derived from the same visual element, they are actually 2 completely different objects as we will discover in a minute.

One of the layers is a text layer, the one we just created. This will have its visibility toggled off. The Shape layer that we conjured, will have its visibility on. These 2 layers can be differentiated via the icon accompanying the layer – T for the Text layer and a star symbol for the Shape layer.

The Shape layer has a contents drop down which can be expanded to find all the individual letters from the text converted into text shapes and each of them act as an object individually. Interestingly, you can add Transform properties to all of these properties separately or to all of them at once as a whole.

The text layer on the other hand is no longer linked to this. You can test this out by changing the text in the text box after selecting the text layer. If you switch the visibility on for this layer, you will notice that two different words are on display in the preview panel.

CREATING SHAPES FROM VECTORS

This is very similar to using the Text tool in After Effects. Let's say for example, that you have a vector created in Adobe Illustrator in excruciating detail. Replicating something similar in After Effects is an extremely tedious and unnecessary ask. What you can do instead is to create an illustration outside of After Effects in Adobe Illustrate and import into AE. Once this is done, you can use this layer as per your will.

One of the options you have is to increase your control over this vector. You can do this a fashion similar to what we did with the text. You can convert a vector into a shape and perform some functions with it.